ISSUE No XIII

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026

⚡ DIGITAL EDITION • 4 EDITORIALS

# TODAY'S EDITORIALS

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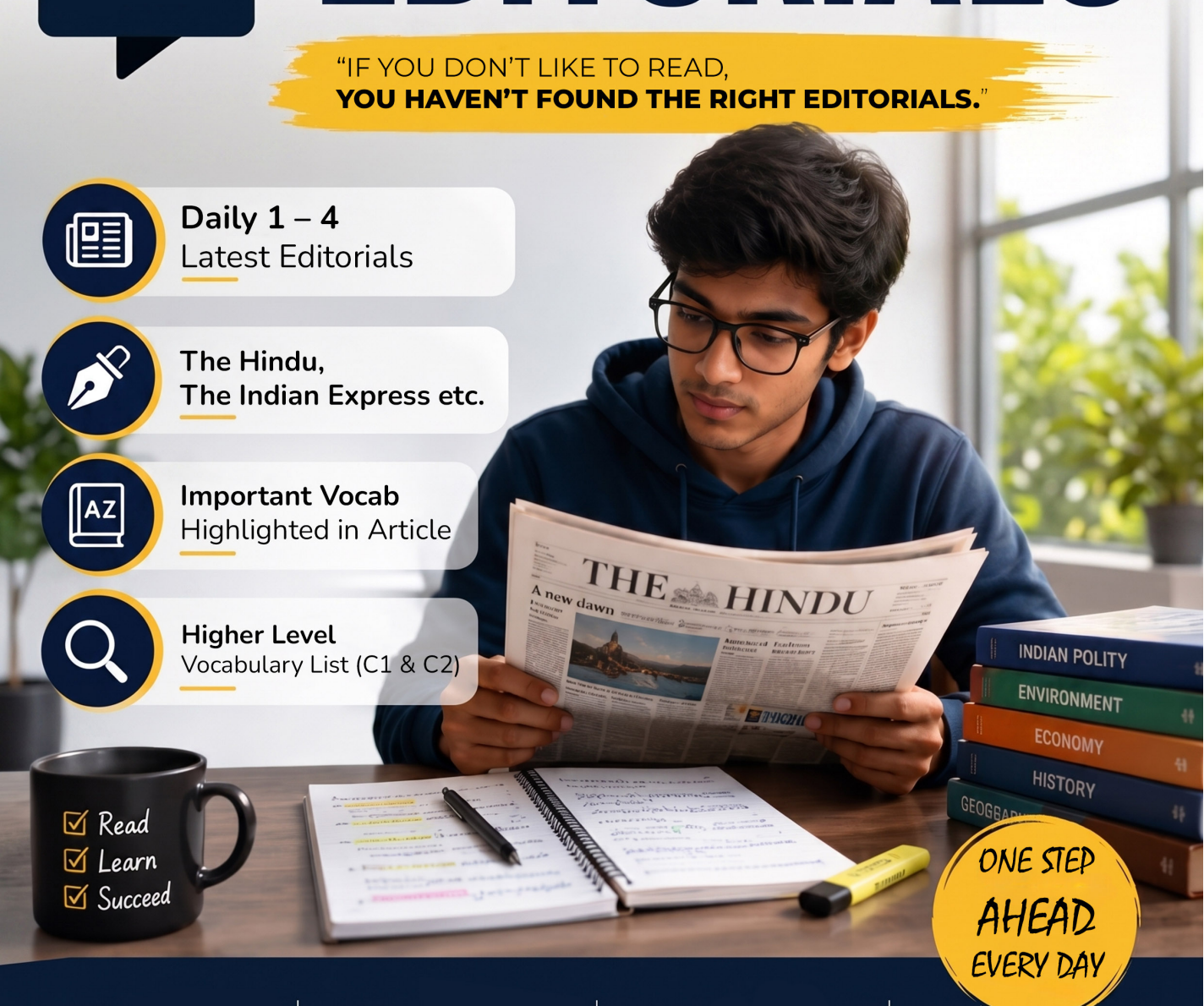

- **Daily 1 – 4** Latest Editorials
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ISSUE No XIII

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026

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> -SARAH J. MAAS

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THE HINDU • INDIAN ECONOMY / MACROECONOMICS

## Endurance test: On the Indian economy's resilience

> Strong Q1 growth faces critical headwinds from volatile oil prices, monsoons, and sluggish demand.

September 2, 2026 • 3 min read • DAILY EDITORIAL READER

India's economic growth during the first quarter of this financial year has surprised most people. Against a **perception**[3] among economists that growth would slow to about 6%-7% **on account of**[4] the impact of the West Asia crisis, real growth in the April-June 2026 quarter came in at a **robust**[5] 7.8%. This was not a statistical **anomaly**[6], either, as growth was **underpinned**[7] by strong performances in both manufacturing and services. In fact, the manufacturing sector grew at a three-quarter-high of 9.2%. The sector has likely benefited from the Goods and Services Tax rate cut implemented last September, and further from the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) 125-basis point **cumulative**[8] interest rate cuts through 2025. A part of it is also that companies likely **front-loaded**[9] their output in the expectation of further uncertainty on inflation, potential future rate hikes, and other possible **headwinds**[10]. The other piece of good news is that capital creation seems to have picked up. While it is not yet clear what the share is between the government and the private sector, capital creation overall has a welcome **multiplier effect**[11] on the economy. The services sector, too, has continued to see **robust**[5] growth, adding strength to the economy. Yet, the economy is not **out of the woods**[12], and this **robust**[5] performance will be more difficult to **replicate**[13] in the quarters ahead. As Chief Economic Adviser V. Anantha Nageswaran has cautioned, Hormuz uncertainty is likely to keep oil prices above $80 a barrel, too high for a country that imports 85%-90% of its oil requirement.

This is perhaps why Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday **reiterated**[14] his appeal to Indians to buy local, avoid non-essential foreign travel and weddings abroad, and stop unnecessary purchases of gold. The pressure of maintaining a reasonable **trade deficit**[15] has so far rested on India's services exports. This has served India reasonably well so far, but the global economy is **stuttering**[16]. This, combined with the growth of Artificial Intelligence services elsewhere, could hurt demand for Indian services exports going ahead. The economy is also yet to face the **full brunt**[17] of a **deficient**[18] monsoon and the impact this will have on rural demand. The consumption-related data for July in the Index of Industrial Production already points to **sluggish**[19] rural demand. While inflation remains well within the RBI's comfort zone, it has been increasing. The RBI expects it to hit 5.9% in October-December 2026, which would further hit demand. The front-loading of manufacturing will also, by definition, **peter out**[20] over the next few quarters. The strength of the Indian economy's **resilience**[2] was tested in Q1 and it passed **admirably**[21]. However, the much tougher **stamina**[22] test remains.

Source: The Hindu    Published: September 02, 2026 12:20 AM IST

**VOCABULARY 101**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Endurance** (Noun) | Stamina • सहनशक्ति / टिकाऊपन |
| 2 | **Resilience** (Noun) | Flexibility • लचीलापन / पुनः संभलने की क्षमता |
| 3 | **Perception** (Noun) | View • धारणा / दृष्टिकोण |
| 4 | **on account of** (Preposition) | Because of • के कारण / की वजह से |
| 5 | **Robust** (Adjective) | Strong • मजबूत / सशक्त |
| 6 | **Anomaly** (Noun) | Oddity • विसंगति / असामान्य बात |
| 7 | **Underpinned** (Verb) | Supported • आधारित / सुदृढ़ किया हुआ |
| 8 | **Cumulative** (Adjective) | Combined • संचयी / कुल मिलाकर |
| 9 | **Front-loaded** (Verb) | Advanced • शुरुआत में ही केंद्रित करना या अग्रिम कर लेना |
| 10 | **Headwinds** (Noun) | Obstacles • विपरीत परिस्थितियां / बाधाएं |
| 11 | **Multiplier effect** (Noun) | Chain reaction • गुणक प्रभाव |
| 12 | **out of the woods** (Phrase) | Safe • खतरे से बाहर |
| 13 | **Replicate** (Verb) | Duplicate • दोहराना / अनुकरण करना |
| 14 | **Reiterated** (Verb) | Repeated • दोहराया / पुनः पुष्टि की |
| 15 | **Trade deficit** (Noun) | Trade shortfall • व्यापार घाटा |
| 16 | **Stuttering** (Verb) | Faltering • लड़खड़ाती हुई / रुक-रुक कर चलने वाली |
| 17 | **full brunt** (Noun) | Main force • मुख्य आघात / पूरा असर |
| 18 | **Deficient** (Adjective) | Lacking • अपूर्ण / कम / अपर्याप्त |
| 19 | **Sluggish** (Adjective) | Slow • सुस्त / मंद |
| 20 | **peter out** (Verb) | Fade • धीरे-धीरे समाप्त होना / क्षीण होना |
| 21 | **Admirably** (Adverb) | Praiseworthily • सराहनीय ढंग से |
| 22 | **Stamina** (Noun) | Staying power • सहनशक्ति / ऊर्जा |

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### EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Endurance test: On the Indian economy's resilience

THE HINDU • INDIAN ECONOMY / MACROECONOMICS

**EDITORIAL STANCE**
**CAUTIOUS**
"mindful of upcoming risks"

**EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE**
The author examines India's impressive first-quarter GDP growth driven by manufacturing and services while noting the domestic and external challenges ahead. By highlighting risks such as elevated oil prices, a deficient monsoon, and stuttering global exports, the editorial warns that sustaining this economic momentum will require navigating significant macroeconomic headwinds.

**EDITORIAL VOCABULARY** — 14 WORDS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Endurance**<br>NOUN<br>POSITIVE | सहनशक्ति / टिकाऊपन<br>The ability to sustain a prolonged stressful effort or challenging situation without giving way. | Think of 'Endure' + 'ance' — the ability to endure hardships till the very end. | stamina<br>durability<br>resilience | fragility<br>weakness<br>debility |
| 02 | **Resilience**<br>NOUN<br>POSITIVE | लचीलापन / पुनः संभलने की क्षमता<br>The capacity to withstand or recover quickly from difficult conditions and shocks. | Sounds like 're-silience' or bouncing back to peace and strength after a disruption. | toughness<br>buoyancy<br>adaptability | vulnerability<br>inflexibility<br>rigidity |
| 03 | **Perception**<br>NOUN<br>NEUTRAL | धारणा / दृष्टिकोण<br>A belief or opinion held by people based on how things seem. | Connect with 'perceive' — the way our senses and mind form an impression of reality. | impression<br>notion<br>understanding | misconception<br>ignorance<br>fact |
| 04 | **Robust**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>POSITIVE | मजबूत / सशक्त<br>Strong, healthy, and vigorous in operation or output. | Sounds like 'robot' — built to be tough, powerful, and durable. | sturdy<br>vigorous<br>resilient | feeble<br>sluggish<br>fragile |
| 05 | **Underpinned**<br>VERB<br>POSITIVE | आधारित / सुदृढ़ किया हुआ<br>Supported, justified, or formed the basis of an argument, system, or growth rate. | Pinning a structure from underneath gives it solid support from below. | buttressed<br>bolstered<br>reinforced | undermined<br>weakened<br>destabilised |
| 06 | **Cumulative**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEUTRAL | संचयी / कुल मिलाकर<br>Increasing or growing by successive additions over a period. | Relate to 'accumulate' — growing by successive additions over time. | aggregate<br>collective<br>accrued | individual<br>discrete<br>isolated |
| 07 | **Headwinds**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | विपरीत परिस्थितियां / बाधाएं<br>Conditions or factors that restrict, delay, or slow down progress and growth. | Winds blowing directly against your 'head', slowing down your forward motion. | impediments<br>hindrances<br>deterrents | tailwinds<br>catalysts<br>boosters |
| 08 | **Replicate**<br>VERB<br>NEUTRAL | दोहराना / अनुकरण करना<br>To reproduce, repeat, or perform an action again in the exact same manner. | Sounds like 'replica' — creating an exact copy or repeating the same feat. | duplicate<br>reproduce<br>emulate | originate<br>deviate<br>diverge |
| 09 | **Reiterated**<br>VERB<br>NEUTRAL | दोहराया / पुनः पुष्टि की<br>Stated or expressed something again, typically for emphasis or clarity. | 'Re-iterate' = iterate (state) again with emphasis. | restated<br>reaffirmed<br>repeated | retracted<br>revoked<br>withdrew |
| 10 | **Stuttering**<br>VERB<br>NEGATIVE | लड़खड़ाती हुई / रुक-रुक कर चलने वाली<br>Progressing irregularly, unsteadily, or with frequent halts and interruptions. | Just like a stutter interrupts speech fluency, a stuttering economy halts and falters. | faltering<br>stumbling<br>hesitating | surging<br>thriving<br>flourishing |
| 11 | **Deficient**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEGATIVE | अपूर्ण / कम / अपर्याप्त<br>Not having enough of a specified quality or ingredient; insufficient. | Linked to 'deficit' — not possessing enough of what is required. | insufficient<br>inadequate<br>scant | abundant<br>adequate<br>surplus |
| 12 | **Sluggish**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEGATIVE | सुस्त / मंद<br>Slow-moving, inactive, or lacking energy and growth. | Slow as a 'slug' that crawls along with minimal pace. | languid<br>inactive<br>torpid | brisk<br>dynamic<br>buoyant |
| 13 | **Admirably**<br>ADVERB<br>POSITIVE | सराहनीय ढंग से<br>In a manner that arouses approval or deserves high praise. | Doing something in a way that makes others 'admire' you. | commendably<br>splendidly<br>laudably | poorly<br>disgracefully<br>deplorably |
| 14 | **Stamina**<br>NOUN<br>POSITIVE | सहनशक्ति / ऊर्जा<br>The ability to sustain prolonged physical or mental effort without tiring. | Athletes need high stamina to stand and run throughout a marathon. | staying power<br>grit<br>vitality | lethargy<br>exhaustion<br>feebleness |

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VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • ENDURANCE TEST: ON THE INDIAN ECONOMY'S RESILIENCE — PART 02

**ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS** — 3 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Anomaly**<br>NOUN<br>NEUTRAL | विसंगति / असामान्य बात<br>Something that deviates from what is standard, normal, or expected. | 'A-normal-y' — something that deviates from what is normal or standard. | aberration<br>irregularity<br>deviation | normality<br>conformity<br>regularity |
| 02 | **Multiplier effect**<br>NOUN<br>POSITIVE | गुणक प्रभाव<br>An economic effect where an initial injection of spending produces a proportionately larger increase in overall economic activity. | Think of multiplying: one initial investment multiplies output across several sectors. | ripple effect<br>spillover effect<br>cumulative effect | diminishing return<br>dilution<br>drain |
| 03 | **Trade deficit**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | व्यापार घाटा<br>The amount by which the cost of a country's imports exceeds the value of its exports. | A 'deficit' in trade means money flowing out on imports exceeds money coming in from exports. | negative trade balance<br>trade gap<br>import surplus | trade surplus<br>positive trade balance<br>export surplus |

**PHRASAL VERBS** — 2 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Front-loaded**<br>VERB<br>NEUTRAL | शुरुआत में ही केंद्रित करना या अग्रिम कर लेना<br>Distributed or concentrated resources, output, or costs primarily at the beginning of a period. | Loading all your cargo in the 'front' portion before moving ahead. | preloaded<br>advanced<br>preponed | deferred<br>postponed<br>back-loaded |
| 02 | **peter out**<br>VERB<br>NEGATIVE | धीरे-धीरे समाप्त होना / क्षीण होना<br>To gradually become smaller or weaker before stopping completely. | Think of a stream getting smaller and smaller until it peters out entirely. | dwindle<br>taper off<br>wane | escalate<br>intensify<br>swell |

**IDIOMS & PHRASES** — 3 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **on account of**<br>PREPOSITION<br>NEUTRAL | के कारण / की वजह से<br>Owing to or by reason of a specified factor. | Think of an 'account' explaining the reason or financial ledger for an event. | owing to<br>due to<br>by virtue of | regardless of<br>despite<br>in spite of |
| 02 | **out of the woods**<br>PHRASE<br>POSITIVE | खतरे से बाहर<br>No longer in danger, difficulty, or jeopardy. | Stepping out of a dark, dangerous forest into open safety. | out of danger<br>clear of risk<br>in the clear | in jeopardy<br>at risk<br>vulnerable |
| 03 | **full brunt**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | मुख्य आघात / पूरा असर<br>The worst part or principal force of a shock, blow, or difficult circumstance. | Brunt sounds like 'blunt impact' — facing the absolute heaviest blow. | full force<br>major impact<br>heaviest burden | cushion<br>mitigation<br>protection |

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 06
Do not gamble: On the Russia-Ukraine conflict →

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THE HINDU • GEOPOLITICS / INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

## Do not gamble: On the Russia-Ukraine conflict

> Escalation risks a wider NATO war, requiring immediate diplomatic engagement to resolve the crisis.

September 2, 2026 • 2 min read • DAILY EDITORIAL READER

With Russia and Ukraine **escalating**[1] their long-range attacks on each other's territory, the risk of the conflict **spilling over into**[2] other parts of Europe is rising. There have been isolated but significant incidents suggesting that Russia is carrying out **'gray zone**[3]**'** attacks, testing the **resolve**[4] of the North Atlantic Treaty Organisation (NATO). Three explosive drones were discovered near a German airport. One was shot down over Romania, while another Russian **projectile**[5] landed in Poland. European officials also say that Russia is recruiting agents for **sabotage**[6] and conducting cyberattacks for digital **espionage**[7]. According to U.S. media reports, U.S. intelligence agencies believe that Russian President Vladimir Putin, **under pressure**[18] at home amid Ukraine's growing long-range attacks, could carry out a cyberattack or a limited land **incursion**[8] into NATO territory in the years ahead. CIA chief John Ratcliffe visited Moscow **in a bid to**[9] warn the Kremlin against **escalating**[1] the war into NATO member-states. Inside Russia, government officials and nationalist voices have **hardened**[10] their **rhetoric**[11]. A Foreign Ministry spokesperson recently said British military facilities "located both inside Ukraine and beyond its borders" may become legitimate targets if Ukraine continues to attack Russia with British weapons. Mikhail Galuzin, Russia's Deputy Foreign Minister, recently threatened to **topple**[12] the regime in Kyiv and establish a new governance body — all suggesting that Russia could be preparing to escalate the war.

Russia still has no clear path to victory. Yes, Russia has taken more than 20% of Ukraine's pre-2014 territory. But its **incremental**[13] territorial gains have slowed. Until early this year, the Russians were using artillery, glide bombs, drones and infantry to blast through Ukraine's deeply **entrenched**[14] positions. But with its long-range attacks, particularly on Russia's energy sector, supply networks, and military systems, Ukraine's new aerial front is **inflicting**[15] economic pain on the Russians. According to some reports, Ukrainian attacks have knocked out roughly 20% of Russia's refining capacity. Russia is also striking Ukraine — its air defences are weak — with drones and ballistic missiles. But with continuing support from Europe, Kyiv has managed to **withstand**[16] Russia's hits. But this **stalemate**[17] is dangerous. **Under pressure**[18] at home and stuck on the frontline, Russia could use U.S. **preoccupation**[19] in the Persian Gulf to escalate the conflict and break the **impasse**[20]. But that would be a huge mistake, as it could trigger an **all-out**[21] war between two nuclear-armed sides. Escalation would only **compound**[22] Russia's problems. Mr. Putin should instead **opt for**[23] serious diplomatic engagement with Ukraine and the West, to find a **middle ground**[24] and end Europe's longest war since the Second World War.

Source: The Hindu    Published: September 02, 2026 12:10 AM IST

**VOCABULARY 101**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Escalating** (Verb) | Increasing • बढ़ाना / तीव्र करना |
| 2 | **Spilling over into** (Prepositional phrase) | Spreading to • दूसरे क्षेत्रों में फैलना |
| 3 | **Gray zone** (Noun phrase) | Unclear area • अस्पष्ट स्थिति |
| 4 | **Resolve** (Noun) | Determination • दृढ़ संकल्प |
| 5 | **Projectile** (Noun) | Missile • प्रक्षेप्य / अस्त्र |
| 6 | **Sabotage** (Noun) | Destruction • तोड़-फोड़ / क्षति पहुँचाना |
| 7 | **Espionage** (Noun) | Spying • जासूसी |
| 8 | **Incursion** (Noun) | Raid • घुसपैठ / आक्रमण |
| 9 | **In a bid to** (Prepositional phrase) | In an attempt to • के प्रयास में |
| 10 | **Hardened** (Verb) | Toughened • कड़ा करना / सख्त करना |
| 11 | **Rhetoric** (Noun) | Persuasive speech • बयानबाजी / वाक्पटुता |
| 12 | **Topple** (Verb) | Overthrow • तख्तापलट करना / गिराना |
| 13 | **Incremental** (Adjective) | Gradual • क्रमिक / धीरे-धीरे बढ़ने वाला |
| 14 | **Entrenched** (Adjective) | Firmly fixed • मजबूती से जमा हुआ |
| 15 | **Inflicting** (Verb) | Causing pain • क्षति या कष्ट पहुँचाना |
| 16 | **Withstand** (Verb) | Resist • सामना करना / टिके रहना |
| 17 | **Stalemate** (Noun) | Deadlock • गतिरोध |
| 18 | **Under pressure** (Prepositional phrase) | Stressed • दबाव में |
| 19 | **Preoccupation** (Noun) | Distraction • व्यस्तता / ध्यानमग्नता |
| 20 | **Impasse** (Noun) | Dead end • गतिरोध / बंद रास्ता |
| 21 | **All-out** (Adjective) | Total • पूर्ण / सर्वव्यापी |
| 22 | **Compound** (Verb) | Worsen • बढ़ाना / जटिल बनाना |
| 23 | **Opt for** (Phrasal verb) | Choose • चुनना / विकल्प चुनना |
| 24 | **Middle ground** (Noun phrase) | Compromise • मध्य मार्ग / समझौता |

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### EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Do not gamble: On the Russia-Ukraine conflict

THE HINDU • GEOPOLITICS / INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

**EDITORIAL STANCE**
**CAUTIONARY**
"warning of dangerous escalation"

**EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE**
The author adopts a cautionary tone to highlight the grave risks of expanding the conflict beyond Ukraine's borders into NATO territories. By referencing covert attacks, hardening rhetoric, and ongoing front-line stalemates, the commentary warns against reckless military moves. Ultimately, the editorial advocates for immediate diplomatic engagement over nuclear-risking escalation.

**EDITORIAL VOCABULARY** — 13 WORDS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Escalating**<br>VERB<br>NEGATIVE | बढ़ाना / तीव्र करना<br>Intensifying or increasing rapidly in magnitude or extent. | An escalator moves UP; escalating means taking conflict UP. | intensifying<br>heightening<br>amplifying | de-escalating<br>diminishing<br>reducing |
| 02 | **Projectile**<br>NOUN<br>NEUTRAL | प्रक्षेप्य / अस्त्र<br>An object propelled or fired through the air by force. | Project + tile: an object projected or launched into the air. | missile<br>rocket<br>shell | target<br>receiver<br>catcher |
| 03 | **Incursion**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | घुसपैठ / आक्रमण<br>A sudden or brief invasion or attack into foreign territory. | In + current: running swiftly into someone else's territory. | invasion<br>intrusion<br>raid | retreat<br>withdrawal<br>evacuation |
| 04 | **Hardened**<br>VERB<br>NEGATIVE | कड़ा करना / सख्त करना<br>Made more unyielding, aggressive, or firm in attitude. | Becoming hard like concrete; unyielding and firm in position. | toughened<br>stiffened<br>entrenched | softened<br>relented<br>weakened |
| 05 | **Rhetoric**<br>NOUN<br>NEUTRAL | बयानबाजी / वाक्पटुता<br>Persuasive or aggressive language, often lacking sincere substance. | Rhetoric sounds like 'orator'—forceful speech used to sway people. | oratory<br>declamation<br>discourse | quietude<br>silence<br>conciseness |
| 06 | **Topple**<br>VERB<br>NEGATIVE | तख्तापलट करना / गिराना<br>Overthrow or remove a government or authority from power. | Top-heavy structures tumble and topple over. | overthrow<br>unseat<br>oust | inststate<br>establish<br>uphold |
| 07 | **Incremental**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEUTRAL | क्रमिक / धीरे-धीरे बढ़ने वाला<br>Relating to or denoting small, step-by-step additions or gains. | Income increasing step-by-step is an incremental change. | gradual<br>step-by-step<br>piecemeal | sudden<br>abrupt<br>rapid |
| 08 | **Entrenched**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEUTRAL | मजबूती से जमा हुआ<br>Firmly established and difficult to alter or dislodge. | Dug deep inside a trench, making removal nearly impossible. | ingrained<br>established<br>deep-rooted | transient<br>precarious<br>unsettled |
| 09 | **Inflicting**<br>VERB<br>NEGATIVE | क्षति या कष्ट पहुँचाना<br>Causing something painful or unpleasant to be suffered. | Conflict inflicts pain on innocent people. | imposing<br>wreaking<br>delivering | alleviating<br>relieving<br>soothing |
| 10 | **Withstand**<br>VERB<br>POSITIVE | सामना करना / टिके रहना<br>Offer strong resistance to or remain undamaged by external force. | Standing firm against strong winds without falling. | endure<br>resist<br>weather | succumb<br>yield<br>surrender |
| 11 | **Preoccupation**<br>NOUN<br>NEUTRAL | व्यस्तता / ध्यानमग्नता<br>The state of being engrossed in or distracted by a specific concern. | Occupied completely beforehand with another pressing thought. | absorption<br>engrossment<br>distraction | inattention<br>indifference<br>unconcern |
| 12 | **All-out**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEGATIVE | पूर्ण / सर्वव्यापी<br>Using all available energy, power, and resources; complete. | Putting all resources out onto the field with maximum force. | total<br>unlimited<br>comprehensive | partial<br>limited<br>restrained |
| 13 | **Compound**<br>VERB<br>NEGATIVE | बढ़ाना / जटिल बनाना<br>Make a bad situation worse or intensify a negative state. | Compound interest adds up fast; compounding errors makes a bad situation worse. | aggravate<br>worsen<br>exacerbate | mitigate<br>ease<br>alleviate |

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VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • DO NOT GAMBLE: ON THE RUSSIA-UKRAINE CONFLICT — PART 02

**ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS** — 4 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Resolve**<br>NOUN<br>POSITIVE | दृढ़ संकल्प<br>Firm determination or willingness to adhere to a course of action. | To 're-solve' a tough problem until success demands strong determination. | firmness<br>resolution<br>fortitude | indecision<br>hesitation<br>vacillation |
| 02 | **Sabotage**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | तोड़-फोड़ / क्षति पहुँचाना<br>Deliberate destruction or damage performed to weaken an enemy or rival. | Throwing wooden shoes (sabots) into machinery to intentionally damage it. | subversion<br>vandalism<br>disruption | protection<br>restoration<br>assistance |
| 03 | **Espionage**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | जासूसी<br>The practice of spying to obtain secret political or military information. | Agent 'Spy-on-age': espionage is the act of covert spying. | spying<br>reconnaissance<br>intelligence-gathering | transparency<br>candour<br>openness |
| 04 | **Stalemate**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | गतिरोध<br>A state where further progress by opposing sides seems impossible. | A stale position in chess where no player can make a legal move. | deadlock<br>impasse<br>standstill | breakthrough<br>resolution<br>progress |

**FIXED PREPOSITIONS** — 1 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Spilling over into**<br>PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE<br>NEGATIVE | दूसरे क्षेत्रों में फैलना<br>Uncontrollably reaching or affecting adjacent areas or subjects. | Imagine liquid spilling over the rim of a glass onto the adjacent table. | overflowing into<br>extending to<br>spreading into | staying contained<br>remaining within<br>receding from |

**PHRASAL VERBS** — 1 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Opt for**<br>PHRASAL VERB<br>NEUTRAL | चुनना / विकल्प चुनना<br>To make a choice from a range of possibilities. | Selecting a specific option from available choices. | choose<br>select<br>decide on | reject<br>decline<br>discard |

**IDIOMS & PHRASES** — 4 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Gray zone**<br>NOUN PHRASE<br>NEGATIVE | अस्पष्ट स्थिति<br>An ambiguous state between peace and open war involving covert or unattributable actions. | Between black (war) and white (peace) lies the unclear gray zone. | ambiguous space<br>shadowy realm<br>unclear boundary | clear distinction<br>black-and-white state<br>explicit territory |
| 02 | **In a bid to**<br>PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE<br>NEUTRAL | के प्रयास में<br>With the intention of or attempting to achieve something. | Making a bid at an auction to attempt to win an item. | attempting to<br>in an effort to<br>seeking to | refraining from<br>avoiding to<br>neglecting to |
| 03 | **Under pressure**<br>PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE<br>NEGATIVE | दबाव में<br>Facing intense stress, strain, or urgency from surrounding factors. | Feeling squashed under heavy weight or high expectations. | strained<br>stressed<br>burdened | at ease<br>relaxed<br>unburdened |
| 04 | **Middle ground**<br>NOUN PHRASE<br>POSITIVE | मध्य मार्ग / समझौता<br>An area of compromise or agreement between opposing viewpoints. | Standing on neutral territory between two opposing sides. | compromise<br>golden mean<br>concession | extremism<br>polarisation<br>intransigence |

**FOREIGN WORDS** — 1 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Impasse**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | गतिरोध / बंद रास्ता<br>A situation in which no progress is possible, especially because of disagreement. | French origin: an 'impossible pass' where no path forward exists. | deadlock<br>stalemate<br>gridlock | advance<br>solution<br>continuation |

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 09
Delhi to Bishkek: Overcoming limits →

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THE INDIAN EXPRESS • GEOPOLITICS & INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

## Delhi to Bishkek: Overcoming limits

> India must overcome regional geographical barriers by deepening bilateral ties and non-physical connectivity.

September 2, 2026 • 2 min read • DAILY EDITORIAL READER

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's address at the 26th summit of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, comes at a time when Central Asia is **diversifying**[1] its partnerships in all directions. A region long shaped by its Soviet past and one that still maintains economic links with Russia, its five countries are now also looking to China for trade, investment and infrastructure, and to Iran and the Gulf for access to the south, though the ongoing conflict **complicates**[2] the latter. The region's growing **strategic**[3] importance and shared security concerns, including terrorism, have led India and all Central Asian countries except Turkmenistan, which maintains permanent **neutrality**[4], to establish **strategic**[3] partnerships. This **evolving**[5] context makes the PM's visit even more significant.

The PM's speech focused mainly on two issues: Connectivity and terrorism. The absence of direct land access has **constrained**[6] trade and wider economic and cultural engagement. There is no overland access through Pakistan, and Afghanistan's airspace remains **beset by**[7] security risks. But connectivity goes far beyond building roads and railways. At its core, it is about shaping the economic and **strategic**[3] geography of Eurasia. India, therefore, must find ways to expand economic engagement while overcoming the **limitations**[8] **imposed by**[9] geography. A starting point could be to focus on products and services that do not depend on roads — services, digital systems and technological investments. On terrorism, the prime minister is right to **call on**[10] the international community to collectively **dismantle**[11] the **ecosystem**[12] of terror, including its financing and **recruitment**[13] networks. The reality New Delhi must recognise, however, is that the international political will against terrorism has weakened. Over the past year, Pakistan has largely overcome its diplomatic **isolation**[14], and it is set to **assume**[15] the organisation's **rotational**[16] chairmanship. In June last year, SCO defence ministers could not agree on the references to terrorism in their joint statement. China **possesses**[17] greater financial resources than any other member and is heavily investing in Central Asian infrastructure as part of the Belt and Road Initiative. Delhi should therefore **place greater weight on**[18] its individual partnerships with member states.

The agreement with Uzbekistan on the long-term supply of uranium is a **step in that direction**[19]. Central Asian countries are emerging as **multi-vector**[20] actors. Rather than choosing between **competing**[21] powers, they are seeking multiple options to improve access to market. India should become one of those options — and use a **multilateral**[22] forum like the SCO to advance **bilateral**[23] relationships. That is a strategy New Delhi should **carry forward**[24] to BRICS, as it prepares to host its 18th summit.

Source: The Indian Express    Published: September 02, 2026 06:00 AM IST

**VOCABULARY 101**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Diversifying** (Verb) | Varying • विविधता लाना |
| 2 | **Complicates** (Verb) | Confuses • जटिल बनाना |
| 3 | **Strategic** (Adjective) | Calculated • रणनीतिक |
| 4 | **Neutrality** (Noun) | Impartiality • तटस्थता |
| 5 | **Evolving** (Adjective) | Developing • विकसित हो रहा |
| 6 | **Constrained** (Verb) | Restricted • बाधित किया |
| 7 | **Beset by** (Verb) | Troubled by • से घिरा हुआ / ग्रस्त |
| 8 | **Limitations** (Noun) | Restrictions • सीमाएँ / बाधाएँ |
| 9 | **Imposed by** (Verb) | Enforced by • द्वारा थोपा गया |
| 10 | **Call on** (Verb) | Appeal to • आह्वान करना |
| 11 | **Dismantle** (Verb) | Deconstruct • ध्वस्त करना / विघटित करना |
| 12 | **Ecosystem** (Noun) | Network • पारिस्थितिकी तंत्र / जटिल तंत्र |
| 13 | **Recruitment** (Noun) | Enlistment • भर्ती |
| 14 | **Isolation** (Noun) | Separation • अलगाव |
| 15 | **Assume** (Verb) | Take on • पदभार ग्रहण करना |
| 16 | **Rotational** (Adjective) | Alternating • आवर्ती / चक्रीय |
| 17 | **Possesses** (Verb) | Holds • अधिकार में होना |
| 18 | **Place greater weight on** (Phrase) | Prioritise • अधिक महत्व देना |
| 19 | **Step in that direction** (Phrase) | Progress • उस दिशा में बढ़ाया गया कदम |
| 20 | **Multi-vector** (Adjective) | Multi-directional • बहु-आयामी (विदेश नीति) |
| 21 | **Competing** (Adjective) | Rival • प्रतिस्पर्धी |
| 22 | **Multilateral** (Adjective) | Multi-party • बहुपक्षीय |
| 23 | **Bilateral** (Adjective) | Two-way • द्विपक्षीय |
| 24 | **Carry forward** (Verb) | Advance • आगे ले जाना |

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### EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Delhi to Bishkek: Overcoming limits

THE INDIAN EXPRESS • GEOPOLITICS & INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

**EDITORIAL STANCE**
**PRAGMATIC / ANALYTICAL**
"practical and strategic analysis"

**EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE**
The author evaluates India's strategic imperatives in Central Asia amidst connectivity hurdles and shifting multilateral alignments within the SCO. Rather than relying solely on fractured multilateral frameworks, the piece advises New Delhi to pursue bilateral economic cooperation and digital linkages. It underscores the necessity of adapting foreign policy to the multi-aligned realities of the Eurasian region.

**EDITORIAL VOCABULARY** — 15 WORDS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Diversifying**<br>VERB<br>POSITIVE | विविधता लाना<br>Expanding into a wider range of different areas, partnerships, or fields. | Think of 'diverse' — expanding in various directions rather than staying in one place. | variegating<br>expanding<br>broadening | concentrating<br>limiting<br>narrowing |
| 02 | **Complicates**<br>VERB<br>NEGATIVE | जटिल बनाना<br>Makes something much more difficult, confusing, or intricate to deal with. | Sounds like 'complex' — making a smooth situation complex and problematic. | entangling<br>confounding<br>hindering | simplifying<br>facilitating<br>clarifying |
| 03 | **Strategic**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>POSITIVE | रणनीतिक<br>Carefully designed or chosen to serve a long-term vital goal or interest. | Linked to 'strategy' — planned deliberately to gain an advantage. | tactical<br>deliberate<br>judicious | unplanned<br>random<br>arbitrary |
| 04 | **Evolving**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>POSITIVE | विकसित हो रहा<br>Gradually changing, developing, and adapting over time. | Think of 'evolution' — continuous, gradual adaptation and transformation. | unfolding<br>advancing<br>maturing | stagnating<br>regressing<br>deteriorating |
| 05 | **Constrained**<br>VERB<br>NEGATIVE | बाधित किया<br>Severely restricted, hindered, or limited in scope or movement. | Sound like 'constricted' — tightened or held back from expanding freely. | curbed<br>impeded<br>inhibited | liberated<br>expanded<br>facilitated |
| 06 | **Limitations**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | सीमाएँ / बाधाएँ<br>Rules, boundaries, or physical conditions that restrict capabilities. | From 'limit' — boundaries that prevent further movement or growth. | constraints<br>impediments<br>shortcomings | possibilities<br>freedoms<br>advantages |
| 07 | **Dismantle**<br>VERB<br>NEGATIVE | ध्वस्त करना / विघटित करना<br>To systematically take apart or destroy an organisation, machine, or structure. | Dis + Mantle (cover/structure) — tearing down the protective framework. | demolish<br>deconstruct<br>disband | assemble<br>construct<br>establish |
| 08 | **Ecosystem**<br>NOUN<br>NEUTRAL | पारिस्थितिकी तंत्र / जटिल तंत्र<br>A complex, interconnected network of supporting elements or institutions. | Eco + System — a complete, interconnected environment that sustains an activity. | structure<br>framework<br>milieu | isolation<br>disorganisation<br>disconnection |
| 09 | **Recruitment**<br>NOUN<br>NEUTRAL | भर्ती<br>The process of enlisting, attracting, or mobilising new members into an organisation. | Re-crew — signing up new members for a crew or organisation. | enrolment<br>induction<br>mobilisation | discharge<br>expulsion<br>dismissal |
| 10 | **Isolation**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | अलगाव<br>The condition of being cut off or alienated diplomatically, socially, or physically. | Think of an 'island' (isle) — cut off and distanced from everyone else. | seclusion<br>ostracism<br>alienation | integration<br>inclusion<br>engagement |
| 11 | **Assume**<br>VERB<br>NEUTRAL | पदभार ग्रहण करना<br>To formally take on, acquire, or enter upon a role, responsibility, or leadership duty. | Assume power — accepting and stepping into a designated office. | undertake<br>adopt<br>shoulder | relinquish<br>surrender<br>renounce |
| 12 | **Rotational**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEUTRAL | आवर्ती / चक्रीय<br>Occurring in turns or cyclical succession among members. | From 'rotate' — turning or passing from one member to the next in turns. | cyclical<br>sequential<br>recurrent | permanent<br>static<br>fixed |
| 13 | **Possesses**<br>VERB<br>NEUTRAL | अधिकार में होना<br>Owns, holds, or has a particular quality, power, or financial capacity. | Possession — having full ownership or command over resources. | commands<br>maintains<br>retains | lacks<br>forfeits<br>yields |
| 14 | **Multi-vector**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEUTRAL | बहु-आयामी (विदेश नीति)<br>Balancing foreign relations across multiple independent strategic and diplomatic fronts. | Multi (many) + Vector (directed path) — pursuing multiple foreign policy pathways at once. | multi-directional<br>polycentric<br>diversified | uni-directional<br>polarised<br>monolithic |
| 15 | **Competing**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEUTRAL | प्रतिस्पर्धी<br>Striving against one another for superiority, resources, or influence. | From 'competition' — two or more parties striving against each other. | contending<br>rival<br>conflicting | cooperating<br>aligned<br>harmonious |

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VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • DELHI TO BISHKEK: OVERCOMING LIMITS — PART 02

**ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS** — 3 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Neutrality**<br>NOUN<br>NEUTRAL | तटस्थता<br>The state or policy of not supporting or helping either side in a conflict or competition. | From 'neutral' like a car gear — not moving towards either side. | non-alignment<br>impartiality<br>detachment | partisanship<br>bias<br>favouritism |
| 02 | **Multilateral**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEUTRAL | बहुपक्षीय<br>Agreed upon or participated in by three or more international parties or nations. | Multi (many) + Lateral (sides) — involving many sides or countries. | international<br>plurilateral<br>collective | unilateral<br>bilateral<br>isolated |
| 03 | **Bilateral**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEUTRAL | द्विपक्षीय<br>Involving or affecting two participating parties, governments, or nations directly. | Bi (two) + Lateral (sides) — directly between two entities. | reciprocal<br>two-sided<br>dual | unilateral<br>multilateral<br>omnilateral |

**FIXED PREPOSITIONS** — 2 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Beset by**<br>VERB<br>NEGATIVE | से घिरा हुआ / ग्रस्त<br>Plagued, troubled, or threatened persistently on all sides by difficulties or dangers. | Be + Set — Surrounded and attacked from all sides by troubles. | plagued by<br>tormented by<br>besieged by | free of<br>unaffected by<br>relieved of |
| 02 | **Imposed by**<br>VERB<br>NEUTRAL | द्वारा थोपा गया<br>Forced upon someone or necessitated by an external condition or authority. | Impose = putting a heavy 'post' or load onto someone by force. | inflicted by<br>levied by<br>dictated by | removed by<br>waived by<br>revoked by |

**PHRASAL VERBS** — 2 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Call on**<br>VERB<br>NEUTRAL | आह्वान करना<br>To formally make a request or appeal to an individual or group to take action. | Calling out loud to someone to ask for their immediate action. | urge<br>summon<br>entreat | discourage<br>ignore<br>dissuade |
| 02 | **Carry forward**<br>VERB<br>POSITIVE | आगे ले जाना<br>To continue development of a strategy, principle, or progress into subsequent stages. | Carrying luggage ahead — transporting an idea or strategy into future venues. | perpetuate<br>maintain<br>propel | abandon<br>halt<br>discontinue |

**IDIOMS & PHRASES** — 2 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Place greater weight on**<br>PHRASE<br>POSITIVE | अधिक महत्व देना<br>To attach more importance, significance, or value to a specific factor or strategy. | Adding heavier weights on a scale to show its higher priority and value. | emphasise<br>accentuate<br>highlight | undervalue<br>downplay<br>disregard |
| 02 | **Step in that direction**<br>PHRASE<br>POSITIVE | उस दिशा में बढ़ाया गया कदम<br>An action or measure that contributes positively toward reaching a defined goal. | Taking a literal physical stride toward an ultimate destination. | stride forward<br>positive move<br>advancement | setback<br>retrograde move<br>regression |

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 12
On packaged foods in India, now a red label, and a long overdue warning →

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THE INDIAN EXPRESS • PUBLIC HEALTH

## On packaged foods in India, now a red label, and a long overdue warning

> Mandatory front-of-pack red warning labels mark a crucial first step against India's surging obesity crisis.

September 2, 2026 • 2 min read • DAILY EDITORIAL READER

**Amid**[1] rapidly expanding concerns about Indians' growing consumption of food high in sugar, **refined**[2] carbohydrates, salt and unhealthy fats comes the FSSAI proposal to implement front-of-pack warnings in the form of red, hexagonal labels on packaged food. Sweetened beverages will carry a separate warning. The proposal comes weeks after the Supreme Court **pulled up**[3] the **apex**[4] food regulator for failing to move on warning labels. It is a welcome step towards addressing **alarming**[5] levels of **obesity**[6], particularly among children — India now ranks second globally, after China, for the number of children who are overweight or living with **obesity**[6].

Given that eating behaviour is complex and influenced by a number of factors, including gender, economic **wherewithal**[7], awareness and faith-based restrictions, there has been **scepticism**[8] about the effectiveness of food warnings. But there is also evidence that such **interventions**[9] can change consumption patterns. For example, Chile witnessed a 24 per cent drop in sugary drink consumption after it introduced black octagonal warning labels on packages in 2016. Clarity and **legibility**[10] are key; a previous FSSAI proposal to use a health star rating system was criticised as such stars are usually **perceived as**[11] positive and warning labels **bearing**[12] them have been **associated with**[13] increased consumption of unhealthy foods.

The notification and timeline for implementation are still awaited. Experts have warned that the two-or-more-unhealthy ingredients **threshold**[14] in the first of the intended two-phase implementation could **leave out**[15] products that are high in just one unhealthy ingredient. There are concerns that the proposed font size may be too small to be effective. Warning labels, finally, can only be one part of a larger approach. Addressing the **obesity**[6] **epidemic**[16] — which exists **alongside**[17] **malnutrition**[18] — will require a broader public-health response that includes raising nutritional awareness, stronger regulation of junk food and **nudges towards**[19] healthier lifestyles. A red label on a packet may not, **by itself**[20], make people eat better, but it is a useful place to start if it makes it easier to **tell**[21] healthy choices **from** harmful ones.

Source: The Indian Express    Published: September 02, 2026 06:05 AM IST

**VOCABULARY 101**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Amid** (Preposition) | In the middle of • के बीच में |
| 2 | **Refined** (Adjective) | Processed • परिष्कृत / संसाधित |
| 3 | **Pulled up** (Verb) | Scolded • फटकार लगाना |
| 4 | **Apex** (Adjective) | Topmost • सर्वोच्च |
| 5 | **Alarming** (Adjective) | Worrying • चिंताजनक |
| 6 | **Obesity** (Noun) | Overweight condition • मोटापा |
| 7 | **Wherewithal** (Noun) | Resources / Means • साधन / आवश्यक धन |
| 8 | **Scepticism** (Noun) | Doubt • संदेहवाद |
| 9 | **Interventions** (Noun) | Actions taken • हस्तक्षेप |
| 10 | **Legibility** (Noun) | Readability • सुपाठ्यता |
| 11 | **Perceived as** (Verb) | Seen as • के रूप में माना जाना |
| 12 | **Bearing** (Verb) | Carrying / Showing • धारण किए हुए |
| 13 | **Associated with** (Adjective) | Linked to • से जुड़ा हुआ |
| 14 | **Threshold** (Noun) | Cut-off limit • सीमा / देहलीज़ |
| 15 | **Leave out** (Verb) | Exclude • छोड़ देना / बाहर रखना |
| 16 | **Epidemic** (Noun) | Widespread outbreak • महामारी |
| 17 | **Alongside** (Preposition) | Together with • के साथ-साथ |
| 18 | **Malnutrition** (Noun) | Poor nutrition • कुपोषण |
| 19 | **Nudges towards** (Verb) | Gently encourages • की ओर धीरे से प्रेरित करना |
| 20 | **By itself** (Adverb) | Alone • अपने आप में / अकेले |
| 21 | **Tell from** (Verb) | Distinguish between • में भेद पहचानना |

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### EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: On packaged foods in India, now a red label, and a long overdue warning

THE INDIAN EXPRESS • PUBLIC HEALTH

**EDITORIAL STANCE**
**CAUTIOUS**
"approving yet mindful of limitations"

**EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE**
The author commends the regulator's overdue initiative to enforce front-of-pack red warning labels to counter rampant childhood obesity. However, the analysis highlights potential pitfalls such as narrow ingredient thresholds and small font sizes that could dilute consumer impact. Ultimately, the editorial advocates for a comprehensive public-health strategy that pairs clear labelling with nutritional literacy and regulatory reform.

**EDITORIAL VOCABULARY** — 9 WORDS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Amid**<br>PREPOSITION<br>NEUTRAL | के बीच में<br>In the middle of or surrounded by events, circumstances, or surroundings. | Think of 'a-mid' as being in the middle of ongoing events. | surrounded by<br>amongst<br>during | away from<br>outside<br>beyond |
| 02 | **Refined**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEUTRAL | परिष्कृत / संसाधित<br>Purified or processed by industrial treatment to remove impurities or coarse elements. | Re-fine means made fine again by removing natural, coarse elements. | processed<br>purified<br>treated | unrefined<br>coarse<br>raw |
| 03 | **Apex**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>POSITIVE | सर्वोच्च<br>Occupying the highest point, level, or position of authority in a hierarchy. | Apex sounds like 'A-peak'—the highest peak of a mountain. | highest<br>supreme<br>paramount | lowest<br>bottom<br>subordinate |
| 04 | **Alarming**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEGATIVE | चिंताजनक<br>Causing great fear, distress, or sudden worry due to severity. | Like an alarm clock waking you up suddenly, alarming news triggers immediate panic. | disturbing<br>disquieting<br>frightening | reassuring<br>comforting<br>calming |
| 05 | **Scepticism**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | संदेहवाद<br>An attitude of doubt or a disposition to question accepted claims and efficacy. | A sceptic keeps an optic (eye) open because they doubt what they hear. | incredulity<br>cynicism<br>distrust | credulity<br>conviction<br>trust |
| 06 | **Interventions**<br>NOUN<br>NEUTRAL | हस्तक्षेप<br>Deliberate actions or regulatory measures taken to alter a specific condition or outcome. | Inter (between) + vene (come) -> to come between events to change the outcome. | involvements<br>mediations<br>measures | non-involvement<br>passivity<br>abstentions |
| 07 | **Bearing**<br>VERB<br>NEUTRAL | धारण किए हुए<br>Displaying, carrying, or exhibiting a specific mark, inscription, or sign. | Like an alarm clock... | carrying<br>displaying<br>exhibiting | lacking<br>omitting<br>shedding |
| 08 | **Threshold**<br>NOUN<br>NEUTRAL | सीमा / देहलीज़<br>The specific limit, level, or boundary at which a reaction or regulation takes effect. | Crossing the threshold of a doorway means entering a whole new room or level. | boundary<br>cut-off point<br>limit | core<br>middle<br>centre |
| 09 | **Alongside**<br>PREPOSITION<br>NEUTRAL | के साथ-साथ<br>Close beside or simultaneously occurring in co-existence with something. | Standing 'along' the 'side' of someone means accompanying them directly. | together with<br>beside<br>in parallel with | apart from<br>without<br>isolated from |

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VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • ON PACKAGED FOODS IN INDIA, NOW A RED LABEL, AND A LONG OVERDUE WARNING — PART 02

**ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS** — 5 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Obesity**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | मोटापा<br>The medical condition of having excessive body fat that impairs overall health. | Obese individuals face high body mass index (BMI) risks. | corpulence<br>fatness<br>overweightness | slenderness<br>underweightness<br>emaciation |
| 02 | **Wherewithal**<br>NOUN<br>NEUTRAL | साधन / आवश्यक धन<br>The financial, material, or logistical means needed for a particular purpose. | Ask yourself: 'Where' is the 'with' to buy 'all' these resources? The means/funds! | resources<br>means<br>finances | inability<br>lack<br>destitution |
| 03 | **Legibility**<br>NOUN<br>POSITIVE | सुपाठ्यता<br>The quality of being clear, distinct, and easily deciphered when read. | If font is 'legal', it must have good 'legibility' to be easily deciphered. | readability<br>clarity<br>distinctness | illegibility<br>indistinctness<br>obscurity |
| 04 | **Epidemic**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | महामारी<br>A widespread occurrence of an infectious disease or harmful condition in a community. | Epi (upon) + demos (people) -> something spreading rapidly upon the entire populace. | outbreak<br>plague<br>scourge | rarity<br>containment<br>endemicity |
| 05 | **Malnutrition**<br>NOUN<br>NEGATIVE | कुपोषण<br>A medical condition resulting from a lack of proper nutrients or insufficient food intake. | Mal (bad) + Nutrition (food intake) = deficient or unbalanced diet. | undernourishment<br>malnourishment<br>dietary deficiency | nourishment<br>healthiness<br>wholesomeness |

**FIXED PREPOSITIONS** — 3 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Perceived as**<br>VERB<br>NEUTRAL | के रूप में माना जाना<br>Regarded, interpreted, or viewed in a particular manner by observers. | To perceive + 'as' always describes how something is regarded by the senses. | regarded as<br>viewed as<br>considered to be | misconstrued as<br>overlooked as<br>ignored |
| 02 | **Associated with**<br>ADJECTIVE<br>NEUTRAL | से जुड़ा हुआ<br>Connected with something else in thought, cause, correlation, or function. | An 'associate' works 'with' someone; things that are linked go together. | linked with<br>related to<br>correlated with | unconnected with<br>unrelated to<br>detached from |
| 03 | **Nudges towards**<br>VERB<br>POSITIVE | की ओर धीरे से प्रेरित करना<br>Gently and subtly encourages or guides someone towards a specific decision or behaviour. | A gentle physical 'nudge' with an elbow moves someone 'towards' taking action. | prompts towards<br>coaxes towards<br>steers towards | deters from<br>dissuades from<br>discourages from |

**PHRASAL VERBS** — 3 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Pulled up**<br>VERB<br>NEGATIVE | फटकार लगाना<br>Severely reprimanded, rebuked, or held accountable for an omission or fault. | When a teacher 'pulls you up' to stand before the class, you are being reprimanded. | reprimanded<br>rebuked<br>admonished | praised<br>commended<br>applauded |
| 02 | **Leave out**<br>VERB<br>NEGATIVE | छोड़ देना / बाहर रखना<br>To fail to include, intentionally ignore, or omit someone or something. | Leaving someone 'out' of the house means excluding them entirely. | omit<br>exclude<br>bypass | include<br>incorporate<br>encompass |
| 03 | **Tell from**<br>VERB<br>NEUTRAL | में भेद पहचानना<br>To recognise or discern the difference between two contrasting things. | Being able to 'tell' one thing 'from' another means your mind can spot the difference. | distinguish from<br>differentiate from<br>discriminate from | confuse with<br>conflate with<br>mix up with |

**IDIOMS & PHRASES** — 1 TERMS

| | | | MEMORY HOOK | SYNONYMS | ANTONYMS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **By itself**<br>ADVERB<br>NEUTRAL | अपने आप में / अकेले<br>Without assistance or extraneous factors; considered purely in isolation. | Acting 'by itself' means functioning in isolation without any external help. | on its own<br>independently<br>in isolation | jointly<br>collaboratively<br>together |

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TODAY'S EDITORIALS
ONE STEP AHEAD EVERYDAY
★

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026

# THANK YOU!

FOR READING. FOR LEARNING.
**FOR GROWING EVERY DAY.**

We're really thrilled to keep working on this. We hope you'll continue supporting this effort until the very end. Most importantly, we hope each one of you achieves success and gets selected in your recruitment exam. ❤️📚✨

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